

Exercise 1.2 — Starting with Requirements

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Project: Preparing for Influenza Season (medical staffing across U.S. states)

Context:

Use past trends by state and demographics to plan when and how many staff to deploy during flu season.

Goal: right staff, right place, right time.

1) Clarifying questions (3)

- **Which** states have the highest influenza burden after adjusting for population (e.g., deaths per 100,000) over the last 5 seasons?
- **When** does flu activity typically start, peak, and end in each state, and how much does that timing shift from year to year?
- **How** many deployable staff do we have by role (nurses, PAs, physicians), and what limits exist on moving them between states (licensing, travel windows)?

2) Funneling questions (3 based on a clarifying question that drill into timing)

- Do earlier-peaking states also have longer seasons, or do they just peak sooner and finish sooner?

- Is the peak week consistent within a state across years, or does it move by several weeks?
- Do neighboring states tend to peak within the same two-week window (useful for regional deployments)?

3) Privacy & ethics questions (3)

- Are all datasets aggregated at state level with no personally identifiable information?
If not, how will we de-identify them?
- How do we share “high-need” states without stigmatizing specific populations or implying blame?
- If vaccination data are only available for children, how do we avoid overgeneralizing results to other vulnerable groups (e.g., 65+, chronic conditions)?

Note:

- The task already provides adjoining and elevating question examples, so they’re not repeated here.